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Exercises for English Phonetics and Phonology

1. ***Give a complete description of the consonant sound represented by the symbol and then supply an English word containing the sound.***

   Example: /tʃ/

   Answer: voiceless alveolopalatal affricate

   Word: Cherry

   a. /ʃ/

   b. /k/

   c. /ŋ/

   d. /ð/

   e. /θ/

   f. /n/

   g. /g/

   h. /s/

   i. /v/

2. ***Give the phonemic symbol representing the consonant sound described and then supply an English word containing the sound.***

   a. Voiced alveolopalatal affricate

   b. Voiceless bilabial stop

   c. Voiced alveolar nasal

   d. Voiced bilabial nasal

   e. Voiceless labiodental fricative

   f. Voiceless glottal fricative

3. ***Give the phonemic symbol for the initial consonant sound(s) in each of the following words.***

   a. room
   b. one
   c. know
   d. Thomas
   e. sure
   f. cereal
   g. jaguar
   h. unity
   i. pheasant
   j. theme
   k. say
   l. chorus
   m. chase
   n. shave
   o. wrong
   p. zero
   q. ghost
   r. science
   s. judge
   t. who

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4. Give the phonemic symbol for the medial consonant sound(s) in each of the following words.

a. toughen
b. visage
c. alloy
d. descent
e. azure
f. away
g. errand
h. ocean
i. adjourn
j. against
k. listen
l. plumber
m. cupboard
n. soften
o. measure
p. author
q. lather
r. psyche
s. future
t. lawyer

5. ***Give the phonemic symbol for the final consonant sound(s) in each of the following words.***

a. froth
b. miss
c. stomach
d. addict
e. ledge
f. itch
g. sign
h. niche
i. hiccough
j. ooze
k. phase
l. with
m. tongue
n. comb
o. brogue
p. mall
q. rough
r. beige
s. hopped
t. solemn

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6. Give a complete description of the vowel sound represented by the symbol and then supply an English word containing the sound.

a. /u:/
b. /e/
c. /ɪ/
d. /ɔɪ/
e. /aʊ/
f. /i:/

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7. Give the phonemic symbol representing the vowel sound described and then supply an English word containing the sound.

a. short low front neutral/unrounded monophthong
b. long mid back rounded monophthong
c. high front (lax) to (upper) mid central diphthong
d. mid front to high front (lax) diphthong
e. long mid central neutral monophthong

8. Give the phonemic symbol for the vowel sound in each of the following words.

a. build	j. fruit	s. proud
b. gauge	k. wolf	t. break
c. threat	l. feud	u. cute
d. plan	m. vein	v. throw
e. earn	n. flax	w. slim
f. brought	o. mourn	x. weigh
g. town	p. style	y. through
h. young	q. heart	z. their
i. stop	r. war	

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9. Each of the following contains one error in transcription; i.e., it indicates an impossible pronunciation of the word for a native speaker of English. Give the word and supply the correct transcription.

Example: /pitsɑ/ word: pizza transcription: /pitsə/

(a) /siːteɪʃən/ (g) /mægɪkəl/ (m) /ɔrðəpiːdɪk/
(b) /centʃəri/ (h) /ɒgsədʒən/ (n) /puːnətɪv/
(c) /sʊnflaʊər/ (i) /briθd/ (o) /kwestən/
(d) /tɔːmkæt/ (j) /strenkθ/ (p) /kʊstəməri/
(e) /ɔɪstərs/ (k) /faɪntli/ (q) /pəplekzt/
(f) /umbrela/ (l) /neɪbərhəd/ (r) /sfɪŋx/

10. Write out the following proverbial expressions, which are given in broad transcription.

(a) /ðərəʊdtəhelɪzpeɪvdwɪðgʊdɪntenʃənz/
(b) /bɜːdzəvəfeðərflɒktəgeðəʳ/
(c) /ərəʊlɪŋstəʊngæðərznəʊmɒs/

(d) /əwɒtʃtketəlnevəˈbɔɪlz/

(e) /tʃærɪtibɪgɪnzæthəʊm/

(f) /evriklaʊdhæzəsɪlvərlaɪnɪŋ/

(g) /greɪtmaɪndzrʌnɪnðəseɪmtʃænəlz/

(h) /menihændzmeɪklaɪtwɜːrk/

(i) /stɪlwɔːtərzrʌndiːp/

(j) /ðiɜːlibɜːdkætʃəzðəwɜːˈm/

(k) /taɪmændtaɪdweɪtfərnəʊmæn/

(l) /ɒpərtjuːnɪtinɒksbətwʌns/

(m) /əfuːlændhɪzmʌniɑːˈsuːnpɑːˈtəd/

(n) /ɔːlwɜːrkændnəʊpleɪmeɪksdʒækədʌlbɔɪ/

(o) /əstɪtʃɪntaɪmseɪvznaɪn/

(p) /ɪtteɪkstuːtəmeɪkəkwɒrəl/

(q) /jukɑːntɜːˈnəsɑʊzɪərɪntuəsɪlkpɜːˈs/

(r) /ənæpələdeɪkiːpsðədɒktərəweɪ/

11. Give broad transcriptions of the following words.

(a)	parochial	(o)	masculine	(bb)	athletic
(b)	ineligible	(p)	debauchery	(cc)	moisturize
(c)	quintessential	(q)	sacrilegious	(dd)	accumulate
(d)	habitual	(r)	deciduous	(ee)	gigantic
(e)	squelched	(s)	authoritarian	(ff)	jewelry
(f)	parliamentary	(t)	literature	(gg)	masochism
(g)	hallucination	(u)	delinquent	(hh)	orthographic
(h)	infuriating	(v)	cucumber	(ii)	sanctuary
(i)	embarrassment	(w)	questionnaire	(jj)	molecular
(j)	relaxation	(x)	psychological	(kk)	suggestion
(k)	exploratory	(y)	thankfully	(ll)	differentiate
(l)	kaleidoscope	(z)	awkwardness	(mm)	calculation
(m)	exhaustion	(aa)	rectangular	(nn)	therapeutic
(n)	museums				

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12. Transcribe the following sets of words and mark primary and secondary stress with Super- and subticks. Note the reduction of vowels in unstressed syllables.

(a) catastrophe

catastrophic

(b) synonym

synonymous

(c) repeat

repetitive

repetition

(d) migrate

migratory

migration

(e) intellect

intellectual

intelligent

(f) apply

application

applicable

applicability

(g) exhibit

exhibition

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13. For each of the following sentences, identify

(a) the number of tone group(s)

(b) the tonic syllable(s) in each tone group

(c) the intonation patterns of each tone group

1. We went to a movie last night.

(topic of conversation: last night's activities)

……

2. We went to a movie last night.

(topic of conversation: going to movies)

……

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3. Should we see a movie tonight?
   (topic of conversation: doing something tonight)

……

4. Should we see the movie tonight?
   (topic of conversation: when we are seeing a movie)

……

5. Should we see the movie tonight, or tomorrow? (two yes/no questions; see 3d, p. 73 in text)

……

6. Should we see the movie tonight, or tomorrow? (alternative question; see 7a, p. 74 in text)

……

7. We could see a movie tonight or go out for ice cream.

……

8. We could visit a museum this afternoon or go to the zoo tomorrow.

……

9. We could go to a movie, couldn't we?

……

10. When should we go to a movie?
    (topic of conversation: our going to a movie)

……

11. When should we go to a movie?
    (topic of conversation: our doing something)

……

12. You liked that movie, didn't you? (tag expressing real question; see 6a in text, p. 74)

……

13. You liked that movie, didn't you? (tag eliciting confirmation; see 6b in text, p. 74)

……

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14. Syllabify the following words, using periods to indicate syllable breaks. Note ambisyllabicity.

1. aroma
2. algebra
3. advocate
4. kangaroo
5. obstinate
6. codify
7. altitude
8. duplicate
9. geometry
10. temperate
11. whiskey
12. integrity
13. appropriate
14. seclusion
15. arithmetic
16. discipline
17. periodic
18. banana
19. insinuate
20. nightingale
21. instrument
22. exclamation
23. already
24. condemnation
25. esthetic

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